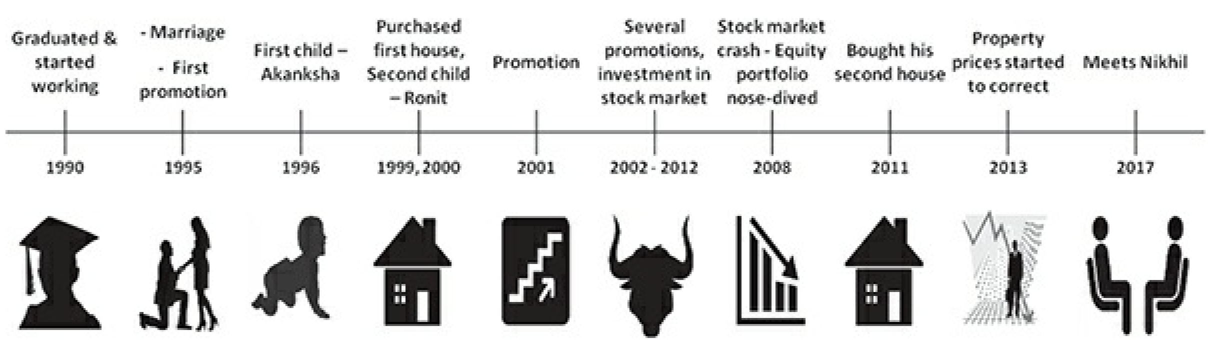
old now and had another ten years of working life ahead of him. Apart from his investment in property, he had some savings in FDs and in gold. He had also taken a few insurance policies whose worth he never got around to assessing fully. Assuming that after his retirement he and Kusum lived for another thirty years, they would need at least Rs 30 lakh per annum post tax to enjoy a comfortable life. An amount of Rs 30 lakh per annum over thirty years was a lot of money. ‘I need at least Rs 9 crore. Where will I get that sort of money from?’ thought Mr Talwar.

Like the Indian innings on TV, his career was also entering its final ten overs, and he had to make it count. How could he make the most of it? The Indian team had held Mahendra Singh Dhoni back for the big hits in the slog overs. Who would bat for Mr Talwar in the slog overs of his career? The question kept troubling him.

Just as he was about to pour himself another peg, Kusum entered the room and said, ‘Shouldn’t we call it a day? Sitting alone in the dark with a glass of Scotch is not going to help. Let’s get some sleep and have a chat over a hot cup of coffee tomorrow morning.’ Mr Talwar sighed. His wife had always been a more level-headed person than him.

Mr Talwar’s life chart: A typical senior executive’s lifeline



Mr Sanghvi has the same troubles as Mr Talwar but with